IT CONSULTANT CHALLENGE 2026 · ROUND 1 PROPOSAL

One order flow. Three markets.

Fixing Company A’s contractor order-to-delivery with an AI order layer that works on top of the systems each country already runs.

Team [Team name] · [Member 1] · [Member 2] · [Member 3] · 26 October 2026

Executive summary

Focus first	Contractor (B2B) orders: today they arrive by email, phone and PDF lists, are re-typed by store staff and promised without reliable stock data.
Why this	It is the one flow where manual work, store inconsistency and late deliveries meet – and it is the base a portal or delivery tracking would need anyway.
Solution	**OrderFlow**: an AI layer that reads orders, matches products, checks stock and lets staff approve in one screen, then posts to each country’s existing ERP.
MVP	12-week pilot in 5–10 Danish stores, email channel only, with clear go/no-go KPIs.
Impact	Base case ≈ DKK 23m a year in staff time returned to selling, faster order confirmation, and one core reused in Sweden and Norway.

Figures are estimates based on stated assumptions (slide 8) · 2

PROBLEM UNDERSTANDING

Four challenges, one broken flow

1 · ORDER ARRIVES

Email, phone, PDF material lists, photos – no standard format.

Fragmented systems: every country receives orders differently.

2 · RE-TYPED BY STAFF

Store staff key each line into the local ERP by hand.

Manual processes – the biggest pain in Denmark.

3 · HANDLED PER STORE

Each store confirms, checks stock and calls back its own way.

Inconsistent operations – the priority in Norway.

4 · DELIVERED TO SITE

Dates promised without live stock; contractors chase updates.

Delivery & fulfilment – the urgent issue in Sweden.

Root cause: there is no shared, structured order layer across the three countries – so every improvement stays local and every order is handled by hand.

Source: case brief; mapping of challenges to the order flow is our analysis · 3

WHO EXPERIENCES IT

Contractors wait, staff re-type

The contractor

Sends a material list from site, waits for confirmation, calls to ask “where is my order?”. A late or partial delivery stops the crew.

The store counter

Re-types lists into the ERP, guesses stock, calls back – time taken away from customers on the shop floor.

Why B2B first

- Larger, repeat orders – each lost contractor costs more
- Most free-text, manual orders come from trade customers [A]
- Competitors (STARK UK, Travis Perkins) now offer delivery windows and live tracking

[A] = our assumption, to be validated in the pilot · Competitor examples: Builders Merchants News; Insight DIY · 4

PRIORITISATION

Why OrderFlow beats the alternatives

Option	Impact	Speed	Feasibility	Reuse	Root cause?
A. OrderFlow – AI order layer	High	High	Medium-high	High	Yes
B. Contractor self-service portal	Medium-high	Low	Medium	High	Partly
C. Delivery slots & tracking only	Medium-high	Medium	Medium	Medium	Sweden only
D. Store task-management app	Low	High	High	High	No

B and C both need A first: a portal or delivery promise only works with structured orders and trusted stock data.

D is fast but cosmetic: it standardises store tasks without touching the flow that costs time and customers.

Ratings are our team’s qualitative assessment against the case criteria · 5

THE SOLUTION

OrderFlow: AI does the typing, staff decide

AI

Read the order

Email, PDF or photo → items, quantities, site, date

AI

Match products

Trade slang → SKU, using catalogue and purchase history

Rules

Check stock

Store and DC stock → a realistic delivery date

Human

Staff approve

One screen; low-confidence lines highlighted

API

Post & confirm

Adapter per country ERP; contractor gets date

No ERP replacement

A thin layer in front of today's systems, replaced step by step – not a big-bang migration.

Built for trust

EU-hosted models, no training on customer data, confidence scores, human sign-off and an audit log.

MVP SCOPE

12 weeks, one country, one channel

Wk 1	ERP integration spike; 500 past orders as test set
Wk 2–6	Order reading + SKU matching, tested offline
Wk 7–9	ERP adapter + staff review screen
Wk 10–12	Live in 5–10 Danish stores; go/no-go

Out of scope: portal, route optimisation, Sweden/Norway ERPs.

Go/no-go KPI [A]	Target
Orders approved without edits	≥ 60%
SKU accuracy after review	≥ 90%
Handling time per order	−60%
Order → confirmation	< 15 min
Wrong item / quantity	−50%

Our Round 2 prototype: AI order reading, SKU matching on a sample catalogue, the review screen and mock DK/SE/NO adapters – built by our team in one week.

Vendor benchmarks: OIKI (IBM) 30→12 min/order; Topa (Lleverage) 90%+ automated – adjacent sectors, vendor-reported · 7

BUSINESS IMPACT

About 120 people’s time spent re-typing orders

DKK 23m

per year in the base case, returned to selling and advising – not headcount cuts.

Stores × orders per day × minutes ÷ 60 × 250 days ÷ 1,650 h = staff on order entry; × time saved × cost per FTE × share realised.

Not counted: retaining contractors through faster, reliable confirmation – measured in the pilot.

Assumption [A]	Low	Base	High
Stores	300	300	300
Manual B2B orders / store / day	15	20	30
Minutes per order	6	8	8
Staff on order entry (FTE)	68	121	182
Time saved	50%	60%	60%
Cost per FTE (DKK)	400k	425k	450k
Share realised	50%	75%	100%
Value per year (DKK)	**7m**	**23m**	**49m**
Payback, full programme	27 mo	6 mo	2 mo

Wages: Statistics Denmark, SSB, SCB (blended DK/NO/SE). MVP ≈ DKK 3.5–6m; programme ≈ 2.5× MVP, run costs excluded · 8

SCALE

One core, rolled out three ways

MONTHS 0–6

Denmark

Pain: manual processes. Pilot, then all stores; add phone notes and photos as channels.

MONTHS 5–9

Sweden

Pain: delivery. Swedish ERP adapter + delivery promise, time slots and live tracking.

MONTHS 8–12

Norway

Pain: store operations. “Counter mode” – one standard way to take orders in every store.

Shared once

AI core, order API, review screen, data model

Local per country

ERP adapter, language and product terms, delivery rules

People first

Employee reps consulted before each wave; store champions

Year 2: contractor portal and AI suggestions on the same order API · Wave pattern similar to JYSK’s Nordic POS rollout · 9

RISKS & NEXT STEPS

What could go wrong – and how we de-risk it

Risk	Mitigation
ERP has no usable order API	Integration spike in week 1; file/EDI fallback; one ERP first
AI mismatches trade slang	Human review, confidence thresholds, test set of real orders
Stock data not accurate	Show confidence on dates; the shared layer improves it over time
Staff or union resistance	Co-design with pilot stores; assistive tool, no headcount cuts
Data protection concerns	EU hosting, data processing agreement, no training on customer data

Next steps

Pick 5–10 pilot stores · confirm ERP access · collect 500 past orders · agree KPIs with store managers and employee reps

Key assumptions: B2B-first, 300 stores, 20 manual orders per store per day, 8 min per order – all validated in the pilot · 10